

Is Alcohol Putting Your Health at Risk?

Drinking too much can harm your physical and mental health.

Below are health risks associated with alcohol when used above the recommended daily/weekly limits.

Heavy drinking can put you at risk for the following:

Cancer risk

- Breast
- Mouth
- Throat
- Liver
- Colon



Sexual and reproductive health issues

- Male: impaired sexual performance
- Female: infertility, risk of birth defects



Worsening mental health issues

- Anxiety
- Depression
- Insomnia or sleep issues
- Anger & violence
- Suicide risk



Risk for chronic diseases

- High blood pressure
- Heart disease
- Stroke
- Liver disease
- Painful nerves (numbness and tingling in hands and feet)



Trouble with learning and memory

- Blackouts
- Dementia
- Poor school or work performance



Increased stomach and digestive issues

- Stomach problems
- Heartburn
- Vitamin deficiencies
- Bleeding
- Ulcers
- Malnutrition



Work and family life

- Work: increased absence, accidents, lower performance, unemployment
- Family: marital conflict, infidelity, higher risk of emotional issues in children, financial strain

Legal troubles

- Impaired driving
- Car accidents
- Loss of custody of children



Feeling sick or having infections

- Frequent colds
- Lower ability to fight off infections like bronchitis or pneumonia



What counts as one drink?



12 ounces

5% *ABV beer,
wine cooler, hard seltzer



5 ounces

12% *ABV wine



8 ounces

7% *ABV malt liquor

1.5 ounces
40% *ABV (80 proof)
distilled spirits (gin,
rum, vodka, whiskey)



*ABV = Alcohol by Volume

You are a heavy drinker if...

You are a
female
who drinks

8



or more drinks in 1 week



OR you have 1 heavy
drinking day per
week, which is more
than 3 drinks a day



You are a **male**
who drinks

15



or more drinks
in 1 week



OR you have 1 heavy
drinking day per
week, which is more
than 4 drinks a day

